

4.10 GRADE DESCRIPTIONS

Grade descriptions are provided to give a general indication of the standards of achievement likely to have been shown by the candidates awarded particular grades. The descriptions must be interpreted in relation to the content specified in Section 5; they are not designed to define that content. The grade awarded will depend in practice upon the extent to which the candidate has met the assessment objectives overall. Shortcomings in some aspects of the assessment may be balanced by better performance in others.

Grade F

Candidates sing and/or play music with some fluency and control of the resources used. They compose music that shows some ability to organise musical ideas and use appropriate resources in response to a brief. They describe musical features using simple musical vocabulary, make improvements to their own work and offer some justification of opinions expressed.

Grade C

Candidates sing and/or play music with control, making expressive use of phrase and dynamics appropriate to the style and mood of the music. They compose music that shows ability to develop musical ideas, use conventions, explore the potential of musical structures and resources and fulfil a brief. They make critical judgements about their own and others' music using musical vocabulary.

Grade A

Candidates explore the expressive potential of musical resources and conventions used in selected genres, styles and traditions. They sing and/or play music with a sense of style, a command of the resources used and making appropriate gradations of tempo, dynamics and balance. They compose music that shows a coherent and imaginative development of musical ideas and a consistency of style and fulfils a brief. They make critical judgements about their own and others' music using accurate and extensive musical vocabulary.

SECTION C: SPECIFICATION CONTENT

5 Specification Content

This specification is designed to offer candidates structured opportunities to develop their knowledge, understanding and skills in **Performing**, **Composing** and **Listening** and **Appraising**. It encourages them to become:

- more **informed** performers through study of their instrument and pieces written for it;
- more **skilled** composers through study of compositional techniques and styles;
- **understanding** listeners through study of a range of different types of music and the backgrounds to them.

The focus for learning in all of these is provided by four Areas of Study: